

FOOD SAFETY

Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why do we wash our hands with soap and warm water before handling food?

FOOD SAFETY

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To get rid of germs that can make food unsafe.

FUN FACT

Washing hands well is one of the best ways to stop germs from spreading.

Source: PNW 250 You can prevent food borne illness

FOOD SAFETY

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Q

What temperature should eggs be cooked to, so they are safe to eat?

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ANSWER

160°F, until the yolk and white are firm.

FUN FACT

Cooking eggs to 160°F kills harmful bacteria like Salmonella.

Source: PNW 720 Proper egg handling

FOOD SAFETY

Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why is it important to keep raw meat separate from cooked foods?

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ANSWER

To avoid germs from raw meat contaminating cooked foods.

FUN FACT

Cross-contamination happens when germs move from raw meat to ready-to-eat foods.

Source: PNW 250 You can prevent food borne illness

FOOD SAFETY

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Q

What does a pH of 4.6 or below mean for food safety?

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ANSWER

The food is acidic enough to stop dangerous bacteria from growing.

FUN FACT

Foods like most fruits and pickles have a low pH which helps keep them safe longer.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics

FOOD SAFETY

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Q

What can happen if low acid foods are stored in oil without acidifying?

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ANSWER

They can grow Clostridium botulinum bacteria that cause botulism.

FUN FACT

Botulism is a serious illness that can come from bad oils with herbs or veggies.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics

FOOD SAFETY

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Q

What is the danger zone temperature range where bacteria grow fastest?

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ANSWER

40°F to 140°F.

FUN FACT

Food left too long in the danger zone can make you sick.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics

FOOD SAFETY

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Q

Why do we refrigerate cooked foods within 2 hours of cooking?

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ANSWER

To keep harmful bacteria from growing on the food.

FUN FACT

Bacteria multiply quickly when cooked food is kept too warm for too long.

Source: PNW 720 Proper egg handling

FOOD SAFETY

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Q

What should you do if a recipe calls for raw eggs but you want to be safe?

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ANSWER

Use pasteurized eggs or cook the eggs to 160°F first.

FUN FACT

Pasteurized eggs are gently heated to kill germs but stay raw.

Source: PNW 720 Proper egg handling

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Q

How often should you clean knives, cutting boards, and surfaces after handling raw meat?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

After every use with hot soapy water.

FUN FACT

Cleaning stops germs from spreading to other foods.

Source: PNW 250 You can prevent food borne illness

FOOD SAFETY

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Q

What should you do with eggs collected from free-range chickens before eating?

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ANSWER

Wash them thoroughly since they can have dirt and feces on them.

FUN FACT

Washing eggs helps remove germs stuck on the shell.

Source: PNW 720 Proper egg handling

FOOD SAFETY

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Q

Why do preserved foods sometimes need to be frozen or refrigerated after opening?

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ANSWER

To stop bacteria from growing and spoiling the food.

FUN FACT

Even safe preserved foods can spoil if left out too long.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics

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Q

What is acidification in food preservation?

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ANSWER

Adding acid (like vinegar) to lower the pH and prevent harmful bacteria growth.

FUN FACT

Pickles are safe because vinegar makes them acidic.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics

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Q

Why do we discard cracked or dirty eggs instead of eating them?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

They can let bacteria get inside and may cause sickness.

FUN FACT

The eggshell protects the inside from germs unless cracked or soiled.

Source: PNW 720 Proper egg handling

FOOD SAFETY

Tweens (10–14)

Q

What happens if cooked food stays in the danger zone (40°F-140°F) for more than 2 hours?

FOOD SAFETY

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Harmful bacteria can grow and cause foodborne illness.

FUN FACT

Bacteria grow fastest between 60°F and 125°F.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics

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Q

Why do pickled foods stay safe longer than some other preserved foods?

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ANSWER

Because their high acidity (low pH) stops bad bacteria from growing.

FUN FACT

Vinegar in pickles keeps them sour and safe!

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics

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Q

If you make herb or vegetable oils at home, why must you store them in the fridge?

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ANSWER

To keep *Clostridium botulinum* bacteria from growing and causing illness.

FUN FACT

Dangerous bacteria grow well in low acid oils stored at room temperature.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics

FOOD SAFETY

Tweens (10–14)

Q

What should you do if you want to keep leftovers safe for eating later?

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ANSWER

Cool them quickly and store in the fridge within 2 hours.

FUN FACT

Cool food fast to stop germs from multiplying.

Source: PNW 250 You can prevent food borne illness

FOOD SAFETY

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Q

Why do harmful bacteria grow more slowly in high acid foods?

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ANSWER

Because acid makes the environment too sour for bacteria to multiply well.

FUN FACT

Acid like vinegar and lemon juice helps keep foods safe.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics

FOOD SAFETY

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Q

If you keep eggs in the refrigerator, where is the best place to store them?

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ANSWER

**In the main part of the fridge,
not the door.**

FUN FACT

The fridge door gets warmer and swings open a lot, which is not good for eggs.

Source: PNW 720 Proper egg handling

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What is the best way to tell if cooked eggs are done and safe to eat?

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ANSWER

They are firm and no longer runny inside.

FUN FACT

Both egg white and yolk should be firm to be safe.

Source: PNW 720 Proper egg handling